

# 4 · Indian National Congress (Formation & Moderate Phase)

SSC CGL Tier I · Modern History · keyword revision notes · pre-Congress associations → formation & theories → sessions 1885–1939 → women presidents & INC opinions · appendix at end

## Last-minute 12

1. **INC founded 1885, Bombay**, by **Allan Octavian Hume** ("Father of Indian Ornithology"); 1st session at Gokuldas Tejpal Sanskrit College, presided **W.C. Bannerji**, 72 delegates, only 2 Muslims, no women
2. Immediate cause: ★ **Ilbert Bill (1883)** — would let Indian magistrates try European-accused cases; introduced under Viceroy Ripon; fierce British backlash ("White Mutiny") forced its dilution/withdrawal
3. 3 theories of INC's formation: **Safety Valve** (Lala Lajpat Rai) · **Conspiracy** (R.P. Dutt) · **Lightning Conductor** (Gopal Krishna Gokhale); Viceroy Dufferin called Congress a "Factory of Sedition"
4. **Dadabhai Naoroji**: "Grand Old Man of India," 1st Indian British MP, presided 3 INC sessions (1886/1893/1906), coined "Swaraj," wrote *Poverty and Un-British Rule in India* (Drain of Wealth); newspapers *Rast Goftar* & *Voice of India*
5. Firsts among presidents: **1887 Madras — Badruddin Tyabji** (1st Muslim) · **1888 Allahabad — George Yule** (1st British) · ★ **1917 Calcutta — Annie Besant** (1st woman) · ★ **1925 Kanpur — Sarojini Naidu** (1st Indian woman) · 1924 Belgaum — Gandhi's only presided session
6. 1896: *Vande Mataram* first sung (Tagore, written by Bankim Chandra Chatterjee) · 1911 Calcutta: *Jana Gana Mana* first sung · 1901 Calcutta: Gandhi's first INC session
7. 1905 Benaras (Gokhale) — Swadeshi formally adopted · 1906 Calcutta (Naoroji) — 4 resolutions: Swaraj/Swadeshi/Boycott/National Education · **1907 Surat** (Rash Behari Ghosh) — Congress split Moderates/Extremists
8. 1916 Lucknow (Ambika Charan Mazumdar) — **Lucknow Pact**: Congress+Muslim League common platform, Congress accepted separate electorates, reunified Moderates & Extremists
9. 1929 Lahore (Nehru) — **Purna Swaraj** resolution; 26 Jan 1930 later declared first Independence Day · 1937 Faizpur (Nehru) — first session in a village
10. 1938 Haripura & 1939 Tripuri: **Bose vs Gandhi** — Bose elected 1938, re-elected 1939 defeating Gandhi's candidate Pattabhi Sitaramayya, then resigned; Rajendra Prasad elected 1939
11. Records: Madan Mohan Malviya presided most sessions · Abul Kalam Azad = youngest president · J.B. Kripalani = president at Independence
12. Pre-Congress bodies: East India Association (1866, London, Naoroji) · Poona Sarvajanik Sabha (1870, Ranade) · Indian Association (1876, Surendranath

## Key

**TRAP** easily confused pair

**PYQ** a real past SSC paper tested this — exact citation given

**DOUBT** sources conflict / unverified

★ tested in history\_pyq.pdf

(exam+date+shift in the appendix) · no personal attempt data exists for this book source, so there are no "my mistake" boxes anywhere in this build

## 1 Associations Formed Before Congress

| Association                                             | Year | Place    | Founder(s)                                                                                                           |
|---------------------------------------------------------|------|----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Bangabhasha Prakasika Sabha</b>                      | 1836 | —        | Associates of Raja Ram Mohan Roy                                                                                     |
| <b>Landholders' Society</b>                             | 1838 | Calcutta | Dwarkanath Tagore (Lucent only)                                                                                      |
| <b>British India Society</b>                            | 1839 | London   | William Adam (Lucent only)                                                                                           |
| <b>British India Association</b>                        | 1851 | Calcutta | Radhakanta Deb & Debendranath Tagore (Parmar) / Devendra Nath Tagore alone (Lucent) — merger of the above two bodies |
| <b>East India Association</b>                           | 1866 | London   | Dadabhai Naoroji                                                                                                     |
| <b>Poona Sarvajanik Sabha</b>                           | 1870 | Poona    | M.G. Ranade (Parmar) / S.H. Chiplunkar, G.V. Joshi & Ranade (Lucent)                                                 |
| <b>Indian League</b>                                    | 1875 | Calcutta | Sisir Kumar Ghosh (also started <i>Amrita Bazar Patrika</i> )                                                        |
| <b>Indian National Association / Indian Association</b> | 1876 | Calcutta | Surendranath Banerjee & Anand Mohan Bose — later merged into Congress                                                |
| <b>Madras Mahajan Sabha</b>                             | 1884 | Madras   | M. Viraraghavachari, G. Subramanian Iyer, P. Ananda Charlu (Parmar) / adds P. Rangia Naydu (Lucent)                  |
| <b>Bombay Presidency Association</b>                    | 1885 | Bombay   | Pherozechah Mehta, K.T. Telang, Badruddin Tyabji                                                                     |

**HOOK** **Dadabhai Naoroji** one-box: 1st Indian British MP · "Grand Old Man of India" · presided 3 sessions (1886/1893/1906) · coined "Swaraj" · 1st National-Income estimate of India (1876), "Father of National Income in India" · papers *Rast Goftar* & *Voice of India* · *Poverty and Un-British Rule in India* (Drain of Wealth) · founded Rahnumai Mazdayasnan Sabha (1851, with Furdonji & Bengalee).

## 2 Formation of Congress

**Founder:** Allan Octavian Hume (also "Father of Indian Ornithology"). 1885: first meeting called for Poona, venue shifted to Bombay (Parmar: due to **plague**; Lucent: due to **cholera** outbreak in Pune — DOUBT). First session: Gokuldas Tejpal Sanskrit College, Bombay, presided W.C. Bannerji, 72 delegates (only 2 Muslims, no women). Lucent adds a prehistory step: Hume first formed the "Indian National Union" (1884), renamed Congress after the Pune/Bombay conference.

★ **Immediate cause: Ilbert Bill (1883).** Would let senior Indian magistrates try cases involving European/British subjects; provoked fierce British backlash (contemporary "White Mutiny"), diluted/withdrawn — exposed the "real face" of British attitudes to Indians and catalysed INC's formation. Introduced under Viceroy Lord Ripon.

Consequence: **Indian Councils Act (1892)** — allowed some Indians to be indirectly elected while keeping the official majority intact.

**HOOK** 3 theories of Congress's origin: **Safety Valve** (Lala Lajpat Rai, ed. *Young India*) — INC as a controlled outlet for discontent · **Conspiracy Theory** (R.P. Dutt) · **Lightning Conductor Theory** (Gopal Krishna Gokhale). Viceroy Dufferin (contemporary): called Congress a "Factory of Sedition."

**DOUBT** Two different Dufferin quotations exist across the two books: Parmar's "Factory of Sedition" (Part A, ch.4) vs Lucent's separate "INC represents only a microscopic minority" (Part B, Select Opinions). Not the same remark; both given, neither verified against an outside source.

**HOOK** Moderate leaders (Lucent's list, selected): Dadabhai Naoroji, A.O. Hume, Badruddin Tyabji, M.G. Ranade, W.C. Bannerji, Pherozeshah Mehta, Surendranath Banerjee, Gopal Krishna Gokhale, Madan Mohan Malviya, Tej Bahadur Sapru, R.C. Dutt.

### 3 Important Sessions of Congress (1885-1939)

| Year  | Place     | President              | Significance                                                                                                                                             |
|-------|-----------|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1885  | Bombay    | W.C. Banerjee          | 1st session, 72 delegates                                                                                                                                |
| 1886  | Calcutta  | Dadabhai Naoroji       | 434 delegates (Parmar) / 436 (Lucent T7, DOUBT)                                                                                                          |
| 1887  | Madras    | Badruddin Tyabji       | 1st Muslim president                                                                                                                                     |
| 1888  | Allahabad | George Yule            | 1st British president                                                                                                                                    |
| 1896  | —         | —                      | <i>Vande Mataram</i> first sung, by Rabindranath Tagore (written by Bankim Chandra Chatterjee)                                                           |
| 1901  | Calcutta  | —                      | Gandhi's first INC session                                                                                                                               |
| 1905  | Benaras   | Gopal Krishna Gokhale  | Swadeshi Movement formally adopted                                                                                                                       |
| 1906  | Calcutta  | Dadabhai Naoroji       | 4 resolutions: Swaraj, Swadeshi, Boycott, National Education                                                                                             |
| 1907  | Surat     | Rash Behari Ghosh      | Congress splits into Extremists & Moderates                                                                                                              |
| 1911  | Calcutta  | —                      | <i>Jana Gana Mana</i> (Tagore) first sung                                                                                                                |
| 1916  | Lucknow   | Ambika Charan Mazumdar | ★ <b>Lucknow Pact</b> — INC+Muslim League common platform (Tilak & Jinnah's efforts); Congress accepted separate electorates; Moderate-Extremist reunion |
| ★1917 | Calcutta  | Annie Besant           | 1st woman president                                                                                                                                      |
| 1924  | Belgaum   | Mahatma Gandhi         | Only session Gandhi presided                                                                                                                             |
| ★1925 | Kanpur    | Sarojini Naidu         | 1st Indian woman president                                                                                                                               |
| 1929  | Lahore    | Jawaharlal Nehru       | Purna Swaraj resolution; 26 Jan later declared 1st Independence Day (1930)                                                                               |
| 1931  | Karachi   | Sardar Patel           | —                                                                                                                                                        |
| 1937  | Faizpur   | J.L. Nehru             | 1st session held in a village                                                                                                                            |
| 1938  | Haripura  | Subhas Chandra Bose    | Bose elected                                                                                                                                             |
| 1939  | Tripuri   | Subhas Chandra Bose    | Bose re-elected, defeating Gandhi's candidate Pattabhi Sitaramayya; Bose later resigned; Rajendra Prasad then elected                                    |

**HOOK** Session records: **Madan Mohan Malviya** presided most sessions · **J.B. Kripalani** was president at Independence · **Abul Kalam Azad** = youngest-ever president.

### 4 Select Opinions about INC (Lucent, contemporary)

| Speaker                                 | Opinion                                                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Lord Dufferin (Viceroy, 1884-88)</b> | "INC represents only a microscopic minority."                                                                   |
| <b>Lord Curzon (Viceroy, 1899-1905)</b> | "The Congress is tottering to its fall, and one of my great ambitions... is to assist it to a peaceful demise." |
| <b>Aurobindo Ghosh (Extremist)</b>      | "INC is a begging institute."                                                                                   |
| <b>Bal Gangadhar Tilak (Extremist)</b>  | "INC should distinguish between begging and claiming the rights."                                               |
| <b>Bipin Chandra Pal (Extremist)</b>    | "INC playing with bubbles."                                                                                     |

I do not have an independently verified source for the exact wording of these quotations beyond the source book itself — treat as the book's own transcription, not confirmed against a primary source.

## A Appendix

### A.1 PYQ citations — every ★ fact in this chapter

| Fact tested                                                       | Exam citation                           | Answer                                                                               |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| What the Ilbert Bill controversy (1883) was related to            | SSC PHASE XIII, 30/07/2025 (Shift-01)   | Rights of Indian judges to try European-accused cases                                |
| The Ilbert Bill controversy of 1883-84 was related to             | SSC CGL TIER-I, 23/09/2025 (Shift-02)   | Rights of Indian judges (granting Indian magistrates trial authority over Europeans) |
| Who was the first woman president of the Indian National Congress | SSC Stenographer, 07/08/2025 (Shift-03) | Annie Besant (1917, Calcutta)                                                        |

The Q1 explanation itself also names Sarojini Naidu as the first *Indian* woman president (1925, Kanpur) — carried into §3 as a paired fact, not separately tested by its own question in this bucket.

### A.2 New facts sourced only from the PYQ book (not in Parmar or Lucent)

None this batch — both directly-tested facts (Ilbert Bill's exact grievance/outcome, the two women presidents) are already present in the raw extraction; the PYQ book's explanations sharpen rather than add to what the source books say.

### A.3 Cross-book & cross-source doubts carried forward

- **Venue-change reason (1885):** Parmar "plague" vs Lucent "cholera outbreak in Pune" — not reconciled.
- **1886 Calcutta session delegate count:** Parmar 434 vs Lucent's own T7 reference table 436 — not reconciled (cross-ref Ch.10).
- **British India Association founders:** Parmar names Radhakanta Deb + Debendranath Tagore; Lucent names Devendra Nath Tagore alone.
- **Two distinct Dufferin quotations** across the two books (see §2 DOUBT box) — not the same remark, neither independently verified.
- **"Conspiracy Theory: R.P. Dutt"** (Parmar) is a different person from "R.C. Dutt" in Lucent's Moderate-leaders list — not the same figure, kept distinct per the raw extraction's own flag.

### A.4 Completeness check

Every fact in `indian_national_congress_raw_extraction.md` Parts A & B is represented above except: Lucent's duplicate-numbered "India National Conference (1883)" row (a near-duplicate of the Indian Association entry, condensed into §1's single row per standing practice) and the raw extraction's own note that Congress-session detail is "best read after the entire Modern History" (a study-order tip, not content). Sessions 1917 onward (Besant through Tripuri) and Cabinet-Mission/Independence-era Congress activity are cross-referenced to Ch.6 (Gandhian Era) and Ch.8 (Quit India & Independence) rather than duplicated, since those chapters carry the fuller narrative around each session's politics.